

Frontend Development Internship

Task 1: Personal Portfolio Website

Project Documentation

Project Name	Personal Portfolio Website
Project Type	Frontend Development Project
Live Website	https://portfolio-nia.netlify.app/
GitHub Repository	https://github.com/04nandini0/portfolionandini-website

1. Project Overview

The Personal Portfolio Website is a frontend web development project built to showcase the developer's technical skills, educational background, project work, and professional journey in a single, self-contained website. It is designed as a digital resume and personal branding platform, presenting information in a clean, modern, dark-themed interface with distinct sections for Home, About, Skills, Projects, Experience, and Contact.

The purpose of the project is to provide a centralized, easily shareable online presence that recruiters, collaborators, and peers can visit to quickly understand the developer's capabilities, view live project demonstrations, and get in touch. It also served as a practical exercise in applying core frontend concepts — layout, styling, responsiveness, and interactivity — to build a complete, production-ready website from scratch.

The target users of this website are recruiters and hiring managers evaluating the developer for internship or job opportunities, fellow developers and collaborators interested in the developer's project work, and any visitor wanting to learn more about the developer's skills and reach out for opportunities.

2. Project Objective

- Design and develop a fully functional, single-page personal portfolio website using core frontend technologies (HTML, CSS, and JavaScript).
- Present the developer's skills, education, and project work in a structured and visually organized manner.
- Implement interactive elements such as section-based navigation, a project filtering system, and a light/dark theme toggle.
- Ensure the website layout adapts to different screen sizes for usability across devices.
- Deploy the completed website to a live hosting platform (Netlify) and publish the source code on GitHub for version control and accessibility.
- Provide a working contact mechanism so visitors can reach out directly through the site.

3. Technologies Used

The website was built using core frontend web technologies, without any external frameworks or libraries, reflecting a strong foundational understanding of HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.

Technology	Purpose
HTML5	Semantic page structure and content markup for all sections (Home, About, Skills, Projects, Experience, Contact).
CSS3	Styling, layout, dark-themed visual design, gradient accents, card components, and responsive layout adjustments.
JavaScript (Vanilla)	Interactivity such as the section navigation, project category filtering, theme (light/dark) toggle, and scroll-to-top behaviour.
Git & GitHub	Version control and source code hosting for the project repository.

Technology	Purpose
Netlify	Deployment and continuous hosting of the live website.

4. Features Implemented

4.1 Section-Based Navigation

A fixed top navigation bar allows visitors to jump directly to the Home, About, Skills, Projects, Experience, and Contact sections. The currently active section is visually highlighted in the navigation bar.

4.2 Hero / Landing Section

The homepage introduces the developer with a headline, role title, a short professional summary, an availability status indicator, and three call-to-action buttons: View Projects, Download CV, and Contact Me. It also displays a row of core technology tags the developer works with (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Python, Java, Git, SQL) alongside a profile image and a decorative code snippet panel.

4.3 About Section

This section provides a personal introduction, a summary of the developer's focus and goals, and three highlight cards — Problem Solving, Real Products, and Continuous Learning — that summarize the developer's working philosophy. It also includes an education timeline listing academic qualifications with institution names, years, and grades.

4.4 Skills Section

Skills are organized into four categories — Programming Languages, Frontend Development, Backend & Database, and Tools & Workflow — with each individual skill displayed alongside a percentage value and a corresponding animated proficiency bar.

4.5 Projects Section with Filtering

The Projects section displays a grid of project cards, each showing a preview image, project title, short description, and technology tags. A filter control at the top (All, Web Apps, UI Projects, JavaScript Projects) allows visitors to narrow down the displayed projects by category. Each project card links out to its individual GitHub repository and live demo.

4.6 Experience / Journey Timeline

A chronological timeline titled "My growth as a developer" walks through the developer's learning progression — from starting web development fundamentals, to building first real-world projects, to expanding into programming and logic-heavy work, along with a stated future goal of mastering full-stack and system design.

4.7 Contact Section

The Contact section includes a working contact form (Name, Email, Message, and a Send Message button) as well as direct contact details: email address, location, GitHub profile link, and LinkedIn profile link — giving visitors multiple ways to reach the developer.

4.8 Theme Toggle

A light/dark mode toggle is available in the navigation bar, allowing visitors to switch the site's colour scheme according to their preference.

5. Design and User Interface

5.1 Layout

The website follows a single-page layout with clearly separated, full-width sections that visitors move through either via scrolling or by clicking the navigation links. Each section uses generous spacing, consistent card-based components, and a restrained colour palette to keep the content easy to scan.

5.2 Navigation

A persistent top navigation bar remains visible as the user scrolls, giving constant access to every section along with the theme toggle. The active link is underlined/highlighted to indicate the visitor's current position on the page.

5.3 Responsive Design

The layout adjusts to smaller screens, reflowing multi-column sections (such as the Skills cards and Journey timeline) into a single, vertically stacked column suitable for mobile viewing, as demonstrated in the Journey/Experience section screenshot captured at a narrow viewport width.

5.4 UI Decisions

- A dark theme with indigo/blue and cyan gradient accents was chosen to give the site a modern, developer-focused aesthetic.
- Monospace styling is used for code-related elements (such as the logo "<NS/>" and the decorative code snippet on the homepage) to reinforce the developer identity.
- Card-based components are used consistently across the About, Skills, and Projects sections for visual uniformity.
- Skill proficiency bars provide a quick, visual way to communicate skill levels rather than relying on text alone.

6. Development Process

6.1 Planning

The project began with identifying the core sections a portfolio needed to include — an introduction, background/education, skills, project showcase, experience/journey, and a way to get in touch — and sketching how each would be structured and connected through navigation.

6.2 Development

The website was built using HTML for the page structure, CSS for styling and layout (including the dark theme, cards, and responsive behaviour), and JavaScript for interactive functionality such as the navigation highlighting, project filtering, and theme toggle.

6.3 Testing

The website was manually tested by navigating through each section, verifying that all navigation links, project filters, the theme toggle, and outbound links (GitHub, LinkedIn, live project demos) worked as expected, and by resizing the browser window to check the layout at different screen widths.

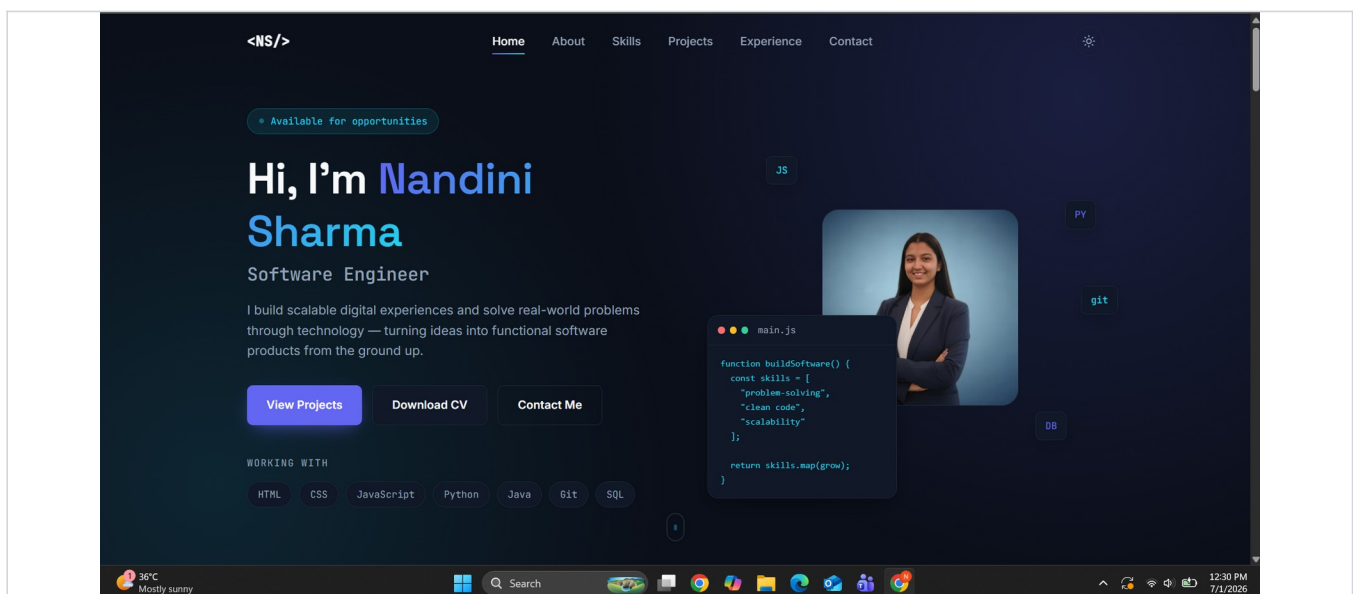
6.4 Deployment

The finished project was pushed to a GitHub repository for version control and public access to the source code, and deployed to Netlify for live hosting, making the site publicly accessible at the URL listed in the Project Links section of this document.

7. Screenshots

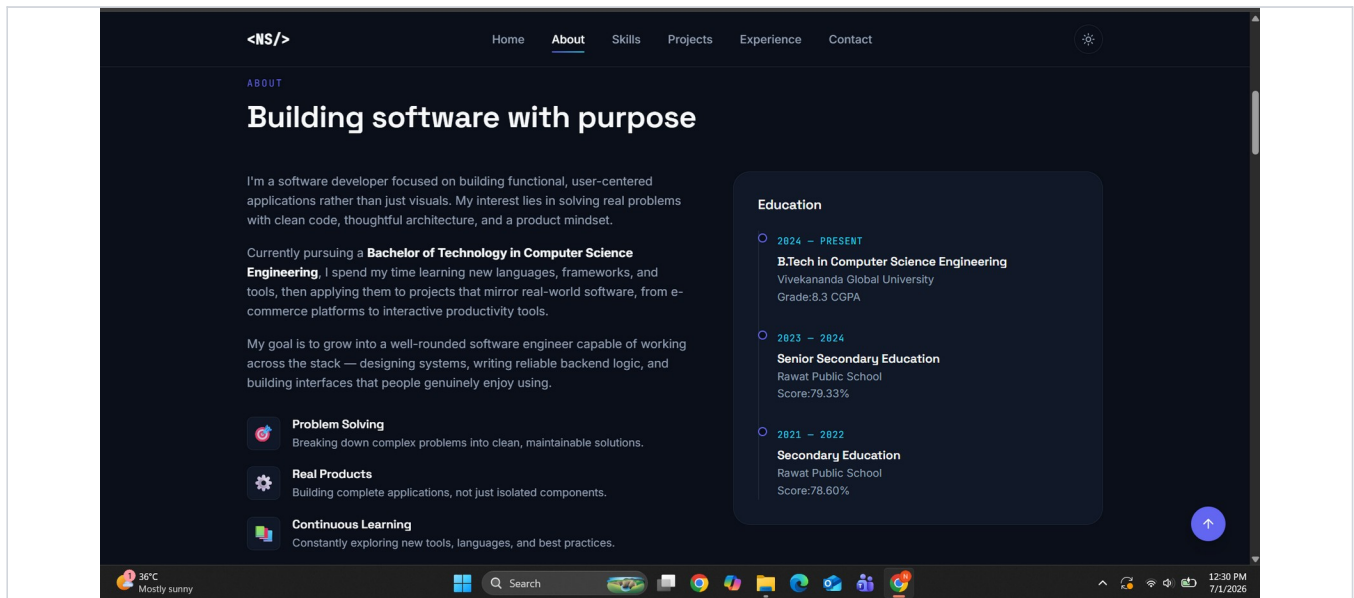
The following screenshots were captured directly from the live, deployed portfolio website.

Figure 1: Homepage / Landing Section



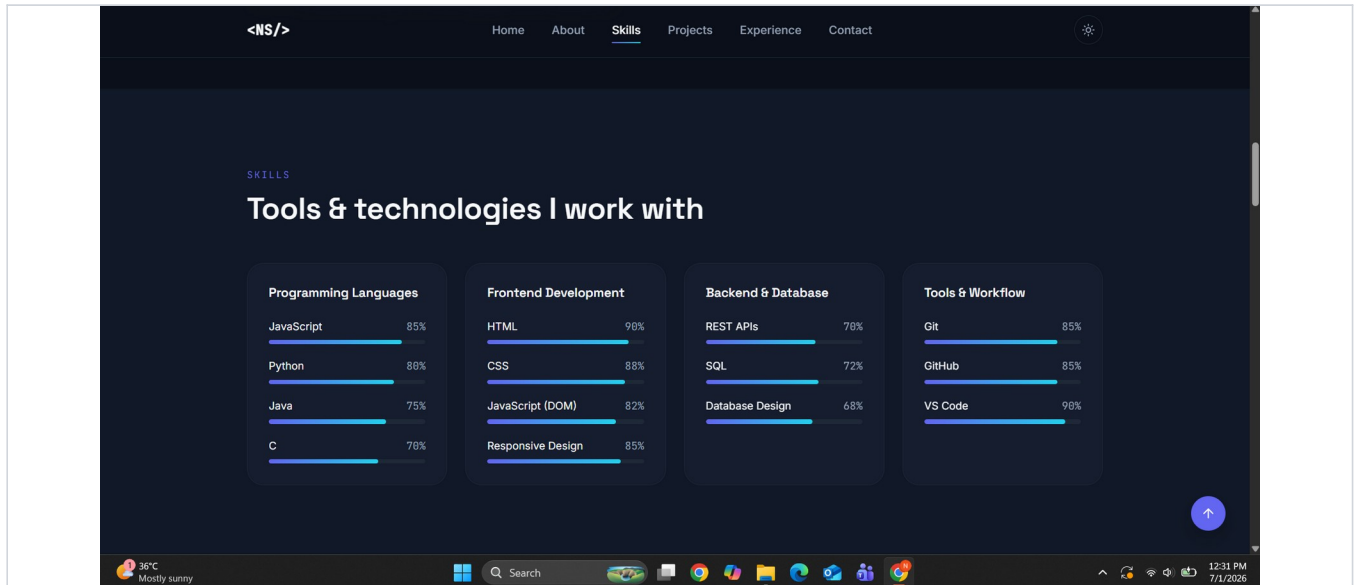
Shows the hero section with the developer's introduction, role, availability status, call-to-action buttons (View Projects, Download CV, Contact Me), core technology tags, and the persistent top navigation bar.

Figure 2: About Section



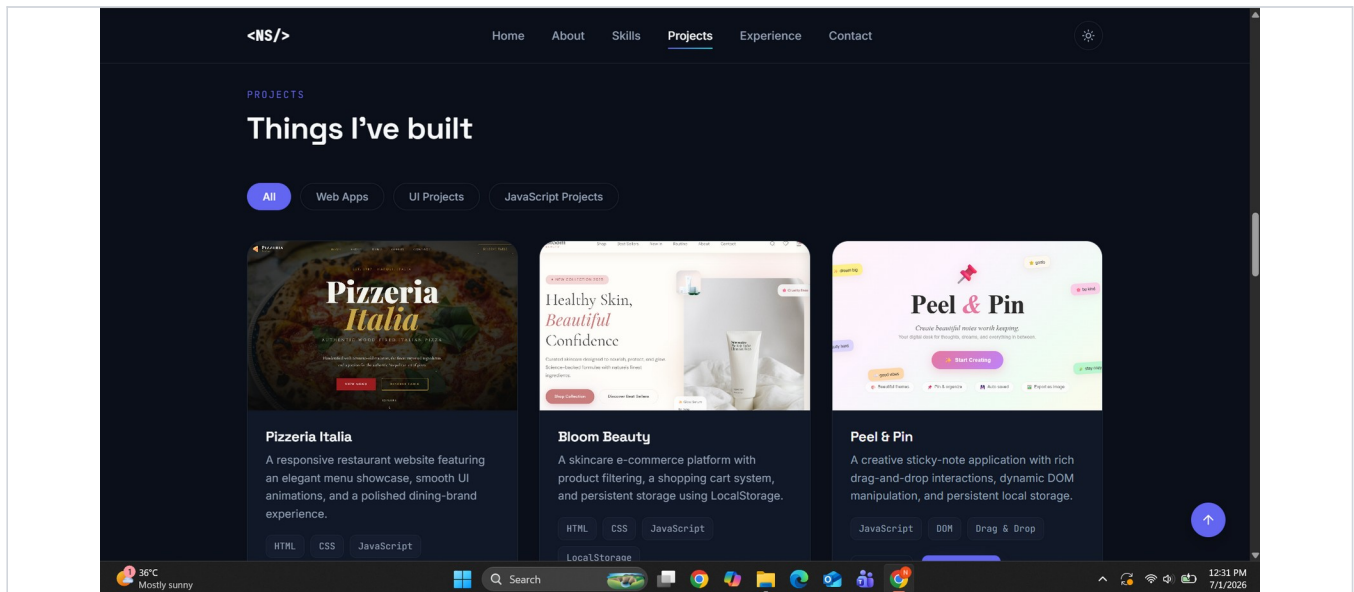
Displays the developer's background summary, the three working-philosophy highlight cards (Problem Solving, Real Products, Continuous Learning), and the education timeline.

Figure 3: Skills Section



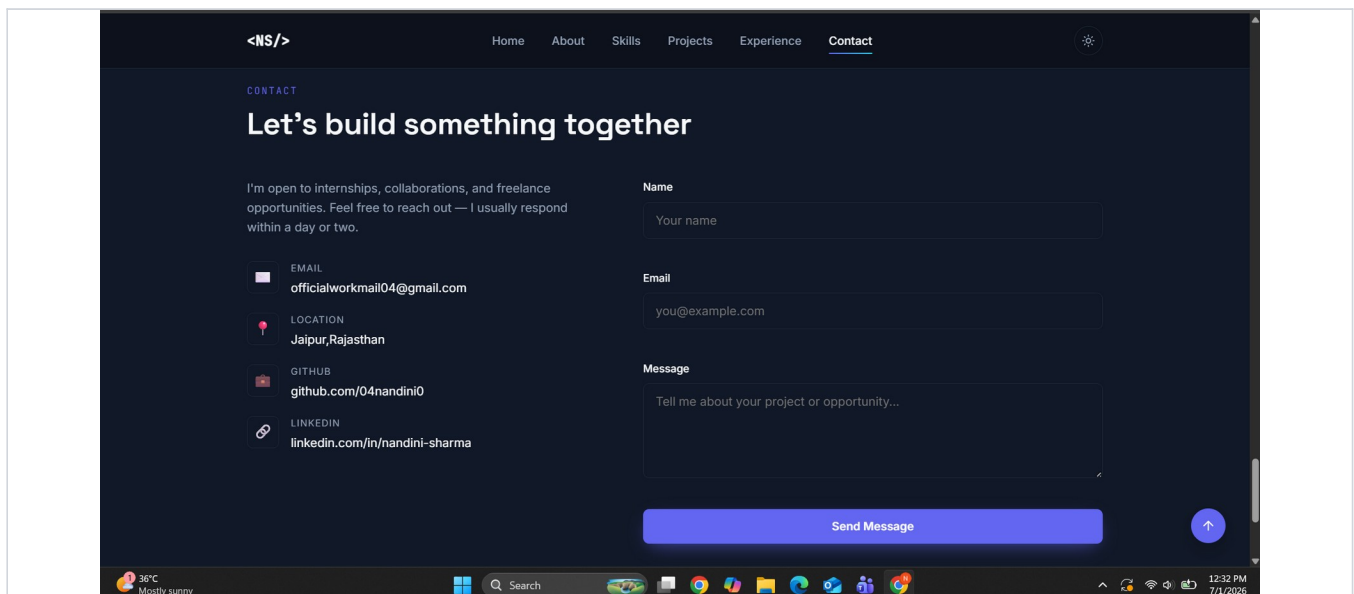
Shows skills grouped into four categories — Programming Languages, Frontend Development, Backend & Database, and Tools & Workflow — each with a percentage-based proficiency bar.

Figure 4: Projects Section



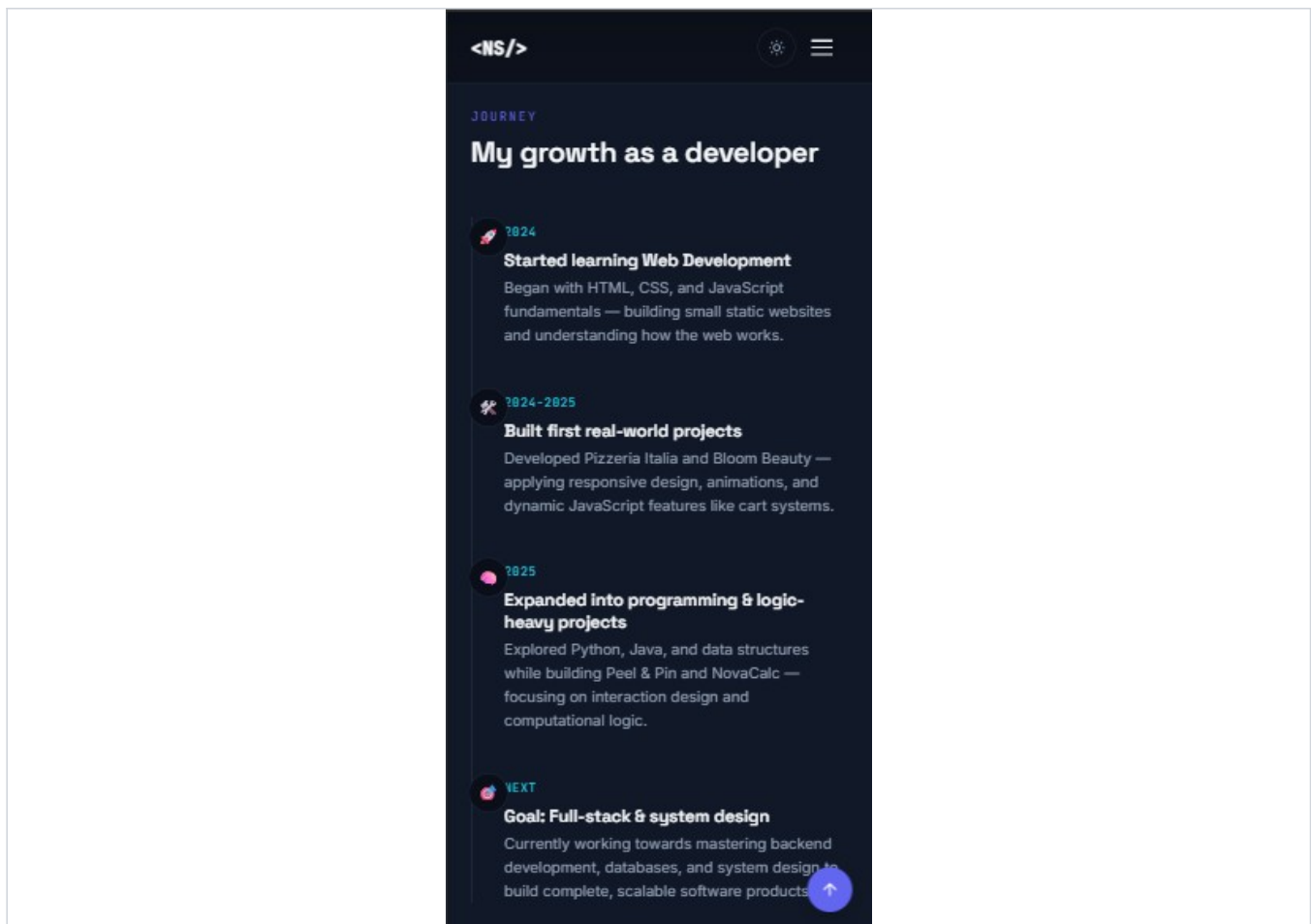
Displays the filterable project grid (All, Web Apps, UI Projects, JavaScript Projects) with project cards for Pizzeria Italia, Bloom Beauty, and Peel & Pin, each showing a preview, description, and technology tags.

Figure 5: Contact Section



Shows the contact form (Name, Email, Message) alongside direct contact details — email, location, GitHub, and LinkedIn — allowing visitors multiple ways to reach the developer.

Figure 6: Journey / Experience Timeline — Mobile Responsive View



Captured at a narrow viewport width, this screenshot demonstrates both the Experience/Journey timeline feature and the site's responsive layout, with content reflowing into a single stacked column suitable for mobile screens.

8. Challenges Faced

- Structuring a single, long HTML page into clearly separated sections while keeping the navigation, active-link highlighting, and smooth scrolling behaviour consistent across all of them.
- Building the project filtering logic in vanilla JavaScript so that clicking a category (Web Apps, UI Projects, JavaScript Projects) correctly shows and hides the relevant project cards without a framework to manage state.
- Designing and implementing the light/dark theme toggle so that colours, contrast, and readability remained consistent across every section of the site.
- Making the multi-column layouts (skills cards, project grid, timeline) reflow cleanly into a single-column layout on smaller screens using CSS alone.
- Maintaining consistent visual styling (spacing, card design, colour palette) across multiple distinct sections to keep the site feeling cohesive rather than like separate pages.

9. Key Learnings

- Practical experience structuring a complete multi-section website using semantic HTML5.

- Stronger command of CSS for building responsive, card-based layouts and a cohesive dark-themed design system.
- Hands-on experience using vanilla JavaScript to implement interactive UI behaviour — DOM manipulation for filtering, event handling for navigation, and toggling UI state for the theme switch — without relying on external libraries.
- Improved understanding of responsive web design principles and how layouts need to adapt across different screen sizes.
- Experience with the end-to-end workflow of a frontend project: version control with Git/GitHub and deploying a live website using Netlify.
- Better appreciation for presenting technical work (skills, projects, experience) in a clear, recruiter-friendly format.

10. Future Improvements

- Connect the contact form to a backend service or form-handling API so messages are actually sent/received rather than only captured on the frontend.
- Add more projects to the Projects section as new work is completed, along with additional filter categories if needed.
- Introduce subtle scroll-based animations to make section transitions feel more polished.
- Improve accessibility by auditing colour contrast, adding ARIA labels, and ensuring full keyboard navigability.
- Consider migrating to a component-based framework (such as React) if the site grows in complexity, to make future maintenance easier.
- Add a blog or writing section to share technical learnings alongside the project showcase.

11. Project Links

Live Demo	https://portfolio-nia.netlify.app/
GitHub Repository	https://github.com/04nandini0/portfolionandini-website